was against the principle of 'mutual and equal security' agreed upon earlier. We were quite clear in our minds that the only leverage we had was the Kailash Range and once that was given up, the PLA would then find some excuse or the other and renege on their commitments for the North Bank. This proposal was rejected outright then and there. Instead, we said, that while the details of the three-day steps were acceptable, the disengagement should commence from the North Bank first. As a token of good faith, we would pull back some of our armour on the South Bank, from Tara Base to Chushul. If this was acceptable, we were willing to commence the disengagement from the 14th as proposed by them, but starting from the North Bank. This, of course, put them in a tizzy and they replied that they would have to 'consult with their authorities'. Although there was no concrete outcome, at least the cards were on the table and there was a starting point for future negotiations and the narrowing-down of differences. We once again suggested that we follow the Galwan Model for the disengagement process, as it had worked well and the area was free from any friction since the disengagement of 6 July.

The eighth round on 6 November 2020 was led by Lt Gen PGK Menon, who had taken over 14 Corps in October, with the JS (East Asia) in attendance. While the eighth round failed to achieve any breakthrough, specifics of a road map towards disengagement were spelt out. The issue of complete restoration of land forms was also clearly brought out, which the PLA had been conveniently silent about. In fact, at one point, they even suggested that the disengagement should be delinked from the issue of restoration of land forms. This was outrightly rejected. If the infrastructure remained, it would make it that much easier to rush back and re-occupy the vacated areas. A true measure of their sincerity would be in the

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